

Coverage Policy: Lumbar Spine MRI Without Contrast

Payer: Test Health Plan

Effective Date: 2026-02-01

CPT Code: 72148

MEDICAL NECESSITY CRITERIA

Prior authorization is required for lumbar spine MRI without contrast.

Coverage requires ALL of the following:

1. Documented low back pain persisting more than six weeks despite conservative therapy (physical therapy, NSAIDs, or activity modification).
2. At least one red-flag neurological finding OR failure of conservative treatment for the condition.
3. No prior lumbar MRI within the past 12 months for the same complaint unless there has been a significant change in symptoms.

This policy applies to outpatient and office settings for adult members aged 18 and older enrolled in a covered plan.